

Presentation Script: The History of SQL (V1)

Slide 1: Title Slide

Hi everyone, today I'm going to walk you through the history of SQL. It stands for Structured Query Language, and for over 50 years, it has been the primary way we talk to databases and manage the world's data.

Slide 2: The Foundation (1970)

It all started in 1970 with this man, Dr. Edgar F. Codd. Before him, data was stored in messy, complicated networks. He proposed a new 'Relational Model' where data is organized into simple, clean tables. This changed everything.

Slide 3: IBM System R

Building on Codd's ideas, two researchers named Donald Chamberlin and Raymond Boyce at IBM created the first version of the language. Their goal was simple: make a language that looks like English so that regular people, not just math experts, could use it.

Slide 4: From SEQUEL to SQL

Interestingly, SQL wasn't the first name. It was originally called 'SEQUEL.' However, an airplane company in the UK already owned that trademark. IBM had to drop the vowels, and it became 'SQL.' Even today, many people still pronounce it 'sequel' as a nod to that history.

Slide 5: Becoming the Global Standard

By the late 70s and 80s, SQL went global. Oracle released the first commercial version in 1979. By 1986, it became an official standard. This meant that no matter what database you used, you could use the same language to talk to it.

Slide 6: The Evolution of Syntax

SQL hasn't stayed stuck in the past. It constantly evolves. In the 90s, it added complex triggers; in the early 2000s, it added XML support; and recently, it added support for JSON and Graph data. It keeps updating to handle new types of technology.

Slide 7: Why It Works (The "What" vs "How")

The secret to SQL's success is that it is 'declarative.' This means you tell the database what you want—for example, 'Give me all employee names'—and the database's brain, the optimizer, figures out the best way to go find it for you.

Slide 8: Adapting to Big Data

In the late 2000s, some thought SQL was dying because of 'Big Data' and 'NoSQL.' But SQL adapted. It now powers the world's biggest cloud data warehouses like Snowflake and BigQuery. It proved it could handle massive amounts of information just as well as the new kids on the block.

Slide 9: The King of Data Today

So, why is it still the king today? It's everywhere. Whether you are using Python for AI, or building a mobile app, or working in finance, SQL is the foundation. It's mature, it's reliable, and it's arguably the most important skill for anyone working with data.

Slide 10: Thank You

That concludes the 50-year journey of SQL. From a research paper at IBM to the language that runs the modern internet. Thank you for listening! Does anyone have any questions?